

# Warden — Content & Brand Style Guide

Antivirus & endpoint security for people who'd rather not think about antivirus.

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## 1. Brand Foundations

**Company:** Warden Security **Tagline:** "Stay Warded." **Category:** Consumer and small-business antivirus / endpoint protection software.

**Mission:** Make world-class security invisible — so people stop noticing it's there and start trusting that it is.

**Positioning statement:** For everyday computer users and small teams who are tired of security software that nags, slows down their machine, and still lets threats through, Warden is the antivirus that works quietly in the background — because unlike bloated legacy suites, Warden was built to be felt only when it matters.

**Boilerplate (for press/bios):** Warden Security builds antivirus and endpoint protection software for people and small businesses who want real protection without the performance hit or the constant pop-ups. Founded in 2019, Warden protects over 4 million devices worldwide. Learn more at [wardensecurity.com](https://wardensecurity.com).

## 2. Brand Personality

Warden is:

| We are...         | Not...                  |
|-------------------|-------------------------|
| Calm              | Alarmist                |
| Direct            | Jargon-heavy            |
| Quietly confident | Boastful                |
| Protective        | Paternalistic           |
| Modern            | Trendy for its own sake |

Think: a good building superintendent. They know every lock, they've seen every trick, and they don't make you feel dumb for asking how the deadbolt works.

## 3. Voice

Voice is constant across every piece of content. Three attributes define it:

**1. Calm, not alarming.** Security marketing loves fear. Warden doesn't. We describe threats accurately without dramatizing them, because panicked customers make bad decisions and stop trusting the brand.

- ✔ "This link tries to install a keylogger. We blocked it before it ran."
- ✘ "WARNING: Hackers could be watching your every keystroke RIGHT NOW."

**2. Plain-spoken, not dumbed-down.** We explain real mechanisms in real language. We don't hide behind "AI-powered next-gen threat intelligence" when we mean "we check files against a list of known bad ones and watch for suspicious behavior."

- ✔ "Warden scans new files the moment they're downloaded and flags anything that behaves like ransomware."
- ✘ "Our proprietary neural heuristic engine leverages next-gen AI to holistically secure your digital perimeter."

**3. Respectful of the reader's time and intelligence.** No fake urgency, no countdown timers, no "act now" unless something is actually time-sensitive. Assume the reader is capable of making their own decision once given clear facts.

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## 4. Tone (how voice flexes by context)

| Context                                | Tone adjustment                                                    |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Product blog / how-it-works content    | Explanatory, a little warm, no jargon                              |
| In-app threat notifications            | Extremely short, factual, zero adjectives                          |
| Marketing / landing pages              | Confident, benefit-led, still calm                                 |
| Security incident or breach disclosure | Sober, transparent, no minimizing, no corporate hedging            |
| Social media                           | Slightly more playful, still never mocks users for getting scammed |
| Customer support content               | Patient, step-by-step, no assumption of technical knowledge        |

**Rule of thumb:** the scarier the topic, the calmer the copy.

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## 5. Audience & Messaging Pillars

### Primary audiences:

- *Home users* who've been burned before (a scam, a slow PC, a scare) and want protection that isn't a hassle
- *Small business owners/IT-of-one* who need real protection but don't have a security team to manage it

### Messaging pillars:

1. **Protection that doesn't get in your way** — low performance impact, minimal interruptions
2. **Clarity over fear** — we tell you what happened and what we did, not just that you should be scared
3. **Built for real threats, not headlines** — protection grounded in actual malware behavior, not marketing-driven "AI" claims

### Approved proof points:

These three claims are **pre-substantiated**. Legal holds the underlying testing on file, so they can be used in published copy exactly as written below, with **no footnote required**:

- Protects 4M+ devices
- Independently tested at 99.7% malware detection
- Under 2% average CPU impact during scans

**Any performance claim that is not on this list requires a source and date in a footnote** — see §9. A figure that merely resembles an approved one is not an approved one: if a number has been rounded, restated, or refreshed from a newer test, it has left the pre-substantiated list and needs its own citation and Brand & Legal sign-off. Quote the approved figure exactly as written, or cite your own source.

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## 6. Language Mechanics

### Grammar & mechanics

- Oxford comma: yes
- Sentence case for headlines and subheads (not Title Case)
- Numerals for all numbers, including one through nine (security content should read like a report, not a listicle)
- Contractions are fine and encouraged — they support the calm, human voice
- Em dashes over semicolons in body copy

### Capitalization

- "Warden" always capitalized; never "warden" or "WARDEN"
- Product line: Warden Home, Warden Business, Warden Endpoint (title case, no italics)
- Generic terms lowercase: antivirus, malware, ransomware, firewall

### Approved terms vs. banned terms

| Use                          | Avoid                                                                                      |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "blocked" / "removed"        | "annihilated" / "destroyed"                                                                |
| "threat"                     | "cyber-monster," "digital predator"                                                        |
| "scan"                       | "sweep" (inconsistent with product UI)                                                     |
| "we detected"                | "our AI detected" (only say AI if it's genuinely a model-based detection, not rules-based) |
| "keep your device protected" | "bulletproof your device" (overpromises)                                                   |

**Claims discipline:** Never say "100% protection," "unhackable," "guaranteed safe," or "virus-proof." No security product can promise this, and the claim will erode trust the first time it's wrong.

## 7. Do's and Don'ts (with examples)

### Headlines

✅ "A ransomware attempt was blocked on your laptop this morning."

❌ "🔴 YOUR LAPTOP WAS UNDER ATTACK 🔴"

### CTAs

✅ "See what Warden caught this week"

❌ "Don't wait until it's too late — ACT NOW!!"

### Feature descriptions

✅ "Warden checks every download against known threats and watches for ransomware-like behavior, even from brand-new files no one has seen before."

❌ "Our next-gen quantum-grade AI shield revolutionizes cybersecurity forever."

### Incident/breach language

✅ "On June 4th, we identified unauthorized access to a subset of customer email addresses. No passwords or payment data were affected. Here's what we're doing about it."

🚫 "We take your security very seriously and are actively monitoring the situation." (says nothing; avoid empty reassurance phrases)

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## 8. Channel Guidance

| Channel              | Length / format notes                                                                            |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Blog                 | 800–1,500 words, one clear takeaway per post, plain-language explainer boxes for technical terms |
| Email                | Subject lines never use scare tactics or emojis for alerts; product emails can be lighter        |
| Social               | Short, can be slightly wry; never mock phishing victims                                          |
| In-app notifications | Under 15 words when possible: "Blocked a suspicious download from [site]."                       |
| Ads                  | Benefit-first, one proof point max, no fear-based hooks                                          |

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## 9. Legal / Compliance Notes

- The approved proof points in §5 are pre-substantiated and need **no footnote** — use them as written. **Every other performance stat** (CPU impact, detection rate, device count, or anything else) must include source and date in a footnote. Proximity to an approved figure is not approval: check the number against §5 before deciding whether a footnote is needed.
  - Never claim compliance with a security standard (SOC 2, ISO 27001, etc.) unless Legal has confirmed current certification status.
  - Incident disclosures must be reviewed by Legal and Security before publishing, regardless of channel.
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## 10. One-Page Cheat Sheet

- **Tagline:** Stay Warded.
- **Voice in 3 words:** Calm. Direct. Confident.
- **Golden rule:** The scarier the topic, the calmer the copy.
- **Never say:** "100% protection," "unhackable," "next-gen AI-powered" (unless literally true)
- **Always say:** what happened, what we did, what the reader should do (if anything)
- **Capitalize:** Warden, Warden Home, Warden Business, Warden Endpoint
- **Lowercase:** antivirus, malware, ransomware, firewall